

who are willing to spend money for it. Good performance across whatever is expected of the gaming laptop. That's one for the mid segment where the performance is important, but still they are looking for, let's say, better value. That means the affordability, their buying power, maybe a bit less. We have a mid-series called Nitro. So, you know, it's somewhere in a better price position. Maybe some changes in terms of the aesthetics, but not the performance. That's the second. And the third is casual gamers who want to use the machine not only for the gaming, but they can use it for any other purpose, entertainment and all that. For them, the values or the pricing is very important. We have our Aspire series. So we try to cater to the different bags, different customer requirements, different affordability quotient by our three series in the gaming laptops.

Q Have there been any notable trends in laptop design and form factor that have emerged recently that you can point out?

A With the changes in the technology, both on the processor and on the GPU, as well as the laptop design has evolved. There are better thermal designs, which we have now, which helps the laptop to become thinner. That means the form factor is now getting squeezed. The battery life is getting enhanced. And therefore, even when you're on the move, you can do some serious gaming. You know, you have time in the airport, you can do some serious gaming. It has also, obviously, the second thing is that the games have evolved. You know, the refresh technology, the display technology is also, I mean, the need of the hour that the display technology needs to change, a better refresh rate, lower response time. All those changes are also required because it has to get you the customer a different gaming experience. So these are the various changes which have evolved. And I'm sure it will continue to evolve as

the technology keeps on advancing. So I will essentially say three, four key directions. One is, of course, the thermal management is changing as the newer and newer GPU and processor technology is evolving. So a better thermal solution at a peak performance level, at a reduced weight and a reduced thickness. So the form factors are getting squeezed. The battery life is getting enhanced. The display technology is definitely becoming better. And of course, ultimately, it should result into a better value proposition for the end consumer.

Q You had initially mentioned how you have three categories, three price segments. You have the Aspire 5 and 7 for budget, Nitro for mid and Predator for high end. We recently had the opportunity to review the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16. This is also Predator. What was the thought process behind the new Neo 16 lineup?

A The positioning of the Predator was for the very, very serious gamers. And accordingly, some of the parameters, both on the processor and GPU etc. were typically high end. So we could talk about an RTX 4080, we could talk about the 13th generation i9 and all those kinds of things. Predator Neo is a new concept which will have the latest generation processor and latest generation GPU. But we are trying to see that some of the other features, if you can look at the production, it does not compromise the processor and the graphics performance. But let's just try to see optimization in the cost structures is what our objective is the introduction of Predator. But at the same time, be trendy, different looks and different kind of things. So that's the thought process behind the Predator.

Q In terms of just hardware specs, doesn't it kind of overlap with the existing Nitro series, like at least the highest end Nitro series?

A It does. But then, you know, since

we also want to cash-in on Predator as a brand, you know, this is an inspirational brand for a gamer who is looking for those kind of things. And yes, to some extent, there will be overlaps in a bit way. But we are still trying to see that, let's say, while on the Nitro series, we can still look at i5 hardware solutions, which we do have. So on the Predator Neo, we are still trying to see that you can have a better CPU and better GPU. But there will be overlap. It's very difficult to actually have a clear black and white. There will be some grey areas where you have the customer. Customer wants to expand for the Predator, but still, you know, it does not have the affordability. So there will be some features here and there in between, which will be common, some will be different. Yes, that's going to be the thought process.

Q So the idea behind the Neo 16 is essentially to make the Predator more reachable.

A Absolutely. The thing because, you know, it's a well-known brand. So obviously, there are changes like, you know, it's not that it's exactly like a Nitro. Thermal management, you know, is a bit different. So that means that Predator Helios Neo, it will be possible for us to scale up the processor and the GPU at a much higher level. While on the Nitro, since the thermal management solution is a different technology as compared to the Predator series per se, therefore, whenever you want to sit in between, then, you know, that's where the Predator Helios Neo will start coming in. While Nitro will not be able to scale up, at least in the current generation to that high level of processor and GPU at that point of time. So we will stick it up to that. Maybe let's say 4060 and all. We will not go to 4070, 4080 because that will not be able to support. So Predator Helios Neo is in between the Predator and Nitro. Some overlaps here, some overlap there. *